MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineer | CI/CD & Test Infrastructure

Wroclaw, Poland | marta.kowalbrandt@example.com | +48 555 303 303 | gitlab.com/mkb-example

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused on CI/CD pipelines, test infrastructure and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and ephemeral test environments for three product teams. Builds hands-on infrastructure skills through a personal k3s GitOps homelab and Terraform provisioning for a Hetzner VPS. Experienced in improving pipeline performance, reducing test flakiness, documenting technical workflows and supporting teams adopting shared tooling. Preparing for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam, scheduled for January 2027.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level work), k3s, Argo CD

Infrastructure as Code & Automation: Terraform (personal projects), Ansible (basic), Bash, Python

Monitoring & Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, GitLab API

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Systems: Linux, Git, Traefik, cert-manager, Java (test code), SQL

Cloud learning: AWS fundamentals (EC2, S3)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevOps Engineer — Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw | 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling workflows, parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data; they are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Enable QA and product teams to review features before merge, with end-to-end tests running against the environments.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built a Python and PostgreSQL workflow to collect CI test results and Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team, helping teams identify and address recurring failures.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and authored an internal guide to CI workflows used in team onboarding.
- Work with namespace-level access on the shared Kubernetes cluster; the platform team operates the cluster.

QA Engineer — Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw | 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications across client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) — Brightmill Software House | 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, reproducing bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps — Personal | 2024–2025

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.

- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments Odrava Health | 2023–2024

- Implemented short-lived application and PostgreSQL environments, deployed via Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI.
- Automated environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity; supported feature review and end-to-end testing before merge.

CI Pipeline Speed-up Odrava Health | 2022

- Profiled CI pipelines across three teams and improved execution through parallel jobs, dependency caching and a separate end-to-end stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BEng, Computer Engineering Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — preparing; exam scheduled for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)